



JAPANESE HANFUDA OR FLOWER CARDS

POPULAR CARD GAMES

In most games, winning is a mix of memory, skill, and luck in how the cards fall.

NAME	TYPE	PLAYERS	OBJECTIVE
Rummy	draw-and-discard	2 or more	combine cards into sets
Bridge	trick-taking	4 players	highest score
Poker	trick-taking	2 or more	hand rankings
Patience	building sets	1 player	complete all 4 sets
Canasta	draw-and-discard	4 players	highest score

A GAME OF CHESS

In a chess game, each player has a black or white army and takes turns to move pieces to attack the other player's king. The aim is to put the king into checkmate — a position where he cannot move to safety. Along the way, players capture enemy pieces and try to keep their own pieces safe.

Black queen sits on black square

CHESS CLOCKS
These clocks control the time spent on each move. The player stops his own timer after a move and starts his opponent's.



Light square in back corner is always on player's right-hand side

Front row has eight pawns

CHESS BOARD SET-UP

The 16 pieces sit on black and white squares in two rows with the eight pawns in the front row. In the back row, two bishops, two knights, and two rooks sit on either side of the queen and the king.

White queen sits on white square
King
Bishop
Knight
Rook

CHESS PIECES

There are 32 pieces in a set — 16 black and 16 white. Each player has one king, one queen, two rooks, two knights, two bishops, and eight pawns.

FULL SET OF BLACK PIECES



KING

The most valuable piece on the board, the king can move one square in any direction. It cannot move into a square occupied by a piece of the same colour or into "check" — a position where it is under threat by an opposing player.



QUEEN

The queen is the most powerful piece on the board. She can move in any direction and for any number of squares as long as her path is clear of her own pieces. If she captures an opponent's piece her move is over.



BISHOP

The bishop is topped by a mitre (bishop's head-dress). It can move any distance diagonally as long as its path is clear. The bishop starts on a light or dark square and must stay on the same colour throughout the game.



KNIGHT

The knight is useful because it can jump over pieces in its path. It moves two squares in any direction and then sideways one square to the left or right. In effect, it sits in the corner of a rectangle three squares by two and jumps to the opposite corner.



ROOK OR CASTLE

Sitting in the corner of the board at the beginning of the game, the rook (or castle) can move backwards, forwards, left, and right as far as it needs to. Its path has to be clear of pieces of the same colour. The rooks are often used to protect each other.



PAWN

Pawns are the smallest and least valuable pieces. Throughout the game, a pawn can move just one square at a time forwards from its starting position. But for its very first move, the pawn has the option of moving two squares forward.

GAMES THROUGH THE AGES

Archaeologists have found ancient game pieces that are more than 5,000 years old. Prehistoric people played games even earlier, with bones that were used like dice.

3100 BCE

3100 BCE
The oldest known board game, Senet is a favourite pastime in Ancient Egypt.



Senet in tomb painting



Backgammon

3000 BCE
A board game similar to backgammon is played.

500 BCE
Pachisi, India's national game, is mentioned in the epic poem *The Mahabharata*.

200 CE
A pottery Go board from this era has been found in Shaanxi Province, China.

700s
Fragments of early mancala games have been found in Eritrea, Africa.



Mancala

1200s
The first mention of the game of dominoes appears in a Chinese text.



Draughts

1492
A knight and lady are shown playing draughts in a medieval book.

c.1850
The Chinese game mahjong is created from earlier versions.



Pachisi

1874
Parcheesi, a version of the ancient Indian game pachisi, is introduced to the USA.

1938
Criss Cross Words (later Scrabble) is invented by a US architect.

1978
Space Invaders becomes a blockbuster arcade video game.



Rubik's cube

1980
Rubik's Cube is launched and becomes the world's best-selling puzzle game.

2000
Computer gamers can set up home and choose how to live in *The Sims*, a follow-on from *SimCity*.

2011
The multi-award-winning computer game *Minecraft* is released.

600s
An ancestor of the game of chess, Chaturanga is referred to in Indian writings.

900s
Playing cards appear in China's Tang dynasty.



Hnefatafl

1230
The Scandinavian strategy game Hnefatafl is mentioned in the Norse Saga.



Cribbage board

1600s
A card game called cribbage, played with a scorekeeping board, is invented.

1886
The first World Chess Tournament is held.

1890s
Snakes and Ladders, based on an ancient Indian game, becomes popular in Victorian England.

1970
A code-breaking game for two players called Mastermind is invented.

1980
Arcade game Pac-Man is released in Japan.

1984
The Trivial Pursuit general knowledge game is a huge success.

2004
World of Warcraft is created — a MMORPG (massively multiplayer online role-playing game).

2015